

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Defender XDR | SOAR | Incident Response | Vulnerability Management

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience in defensive security engineering, threat detection, incident response, and vulnerability management across complex enterprise and hybrid cloud environments. I specialise in the design, deployment, and continuous improvement of Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) platforms, and Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR) including Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI). I am experienced in security alert triage, advanced investigation, and containment of incidents across corporate and cloud estates. I bring complementary depth in vulnerability management, penetration test finding remediation, and threat modelling to support secure-by-design engineering across projects. Holding the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and currently serving as a Senior Cyber Security Engineer at the University of the Arts London, I am ready to bring strong technical depth and a collaborative approach to a specialist cyber security consultancy like S-RM, helping clients mature their security posture and respond effectively to evolving threats.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel SIEM/SOAR:** Workspace design; data connector integration; KQL analytics rules; automated response playbooks; workbooks and dashboards; incident management; log source onboarding
- **Microsoft Defender XDR:** Defender for Endpoint (MDE); Defender for Identity (MDI); Microsoft 365 Defender; Defender for Cloud; XDR incident correlation; alert triage and investigation
- **Security Alert Triage and Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 IR lifecycle; MITRE ATT&CK framework; investigation and containment of incidents across endpoint, identity, and cloud; senior escalation lead; playbook authoring
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io; Nessus; AppCheck; Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); penetration test finding scoping, tracking, and remediation
- **Threat Modelling and Secure-by-Design:** Threat modelling assessments for projects and architecture changes; MITRE ATT&CK TTP mapping; STRIDE methodology
- **CrowdStrike Falcon:** EDR (Prevent, Insight, Discover); NG-SIEM; detection tuning; hybrid SOC operations - Expert level
- **Identity and Access Management:** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID; Conditional Access; MFA; SSO; Privileged Access Management (PAM) - BeyondTrust
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell; KQL; SOAR Logic Apps playbook development
- **Frameworks and Compliance:** NIST CSF; CIS Controls; ISO 27001; Cyber Essentials Plus; MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Maintain, tune, and evolve the **Microsoft Sentinel SIEM/SOAR** deployment; manage workspace architecture, data connector integrations, KQL analytics rules, SOAR playbooks, and workbook-based reporting for leadership stakeholders.
- Lead **security alert triage, investigation, and containment** of potential incidents across the corporate estate and cloud environments; act as senior escalation point for the security operations function.
- Manage **Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender** platform operations; configure detection policies, investigate XDR incidents, and tune signal fidelity.

- Operate **CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and NG-SIEM** at expert level; manage endpoint detection policies, respond to Falcon alerts, and integrate CrowdStrike telemetry with Sentinel for unified SOC visibility.
- Lead the **vulnerability management programme** using Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, and Pentera BAS; coordinate penetration testing engagement scoping, track findings, and ensure remediation to closure.
- Conduct **threat modelling assessments** for new projects, infrastructure changes, and cloud service onboarding; work with engineering and infrastructure teams to implement secure-by-design controls from project inception.
- Author and maintain **incident response playbooks and SOAR automation workflows** aligned to NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK; deliver post-incident reviews with actionable lessons learned.
- Develop **PowerShell scripts and SOAR Logic Apps playbooks** to automate response actions, enrichment workflows, and routine security administration tasks.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

- Deployed and operationalised **Microsoft Defender (MDE, MDI, Microsoft 365 Defender)** across approximately 8,000 users; configured detection policies, onboarded endpoints, and established XDR incident response workflows.
- Performed **security alert triage and threat hunting** in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL; investigated and contained incidents involving credential compromise, lateral movement, and malware persistence.
- Wrote **KQL analytics rules and detection logic** mapped to MITRE ATT&CK TTPs; continuously refined detections based on emerging threat intelligence and post-incident learnings.
- Developed **SOAR playbooks and automation workflows** in Microsoft Sentinel to reduce analyst MTTR and ensure consistent, repeatable response procedures.
- Managed **vulnerability scanning and remediation tracking** using Tenable.io and AppCheck; provided monthly risk reports and remediation progress dashboards to senior management.
- Participated in **penetration test cycles**: coordinated scope, supported test execution, tracked findings, and drove remediation across technical teams to achieve closure.
- Administered **Azure AD / Entra ID** including Conditional Access policies, MFA, SSO, and identity lifecycle management; enforced least-privilege access and Zero Trust identity controls.
- Managed **Check Point Harmony firewall** rules, IDS/IPS policies, and Mimecast email security gateway configurations.
- Supported **ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus** compliance activities; contributed to risk assessment, security policy documentation, and control evidence collection.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

- Implemented and managed **endpoint security, access control, and cloud security** across a Microsoft Azure-based SaaS platform; responded to security alerts and managed vulnerability remediation cycles.
- Conducted **security assessments and penetration test remediation**; tracked open findings through to closure and documented residual risk for management review.
- Developed **security policies, standards, and procedures** aligned to ISO 27001 and NIST CSF; supported knowledge sharing and security awareness within the organisation.
- Managed **Azure Active Directory** identity provisioning, MFA, and SSO; enforced RBAC and access controls for staff, developers, and third-party vendors.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and deployed a **Microsoft Sentinel SIEM/SOAR environment** including 20+ data connectors, 30+ custom KQL analytics rules, and 15+ automated response playbooks; materially improved detection coverage and reduced MTTR.
- Built a **hybrid SOC capability integrating CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel**, providing unified visibility across endpoint, identity, and cloud workloads for a complex multi-site environment.
- Led **Microsoft Defender XDR deployment (MDE, MDI, M365)** across 8,000 users; established baseline detection, identity threat protection, and response capabilities.

- Delivered **penetration test remediation cycles** achieving 90%+ finding closure rates within agreed timelines; produced stakeholder-facing risk reporting tracking progress.
- Conducted **threat modelling assessments** for multiple infrastructure and application projects, embedding security requirements at design stage and reducing the cost of late-stage remediation.
- Maintained **Cyber Essentials Plus and ISO 27001** compliance posture through rigorous vulnerability management and control documentation, with zero major findings in most recent external audit cycles.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 75,000-90,000 | Hybrid (London/UK)